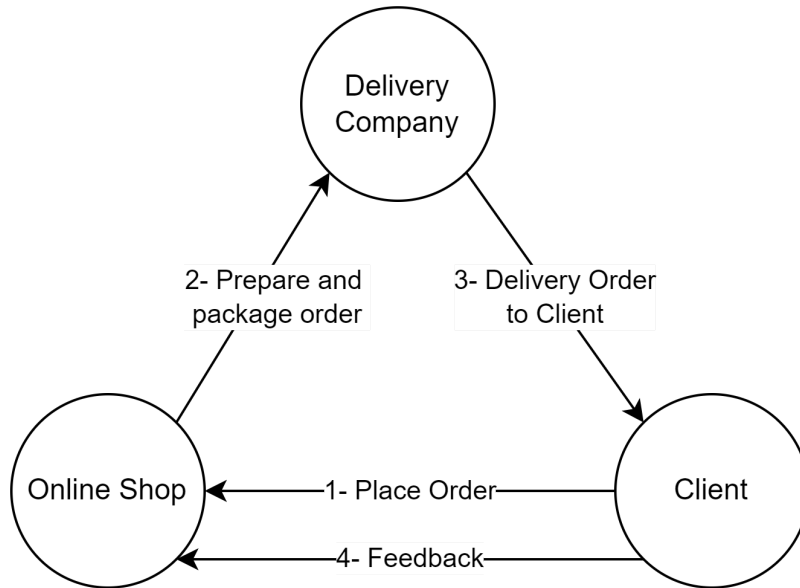


Delivery Company Platform

Introduction:

In the world of online shopping, clients browse the online shops for products they need and place orders. Online shops then pack their products, send the package to the delivery company, which will then deliver this order to the client. The client after that may or may not give a feedback to the online shop.

The diagram below summarizes the overall high level process.



As it's clear from the above diagram, the main stakeholders of the delivery platform product are:

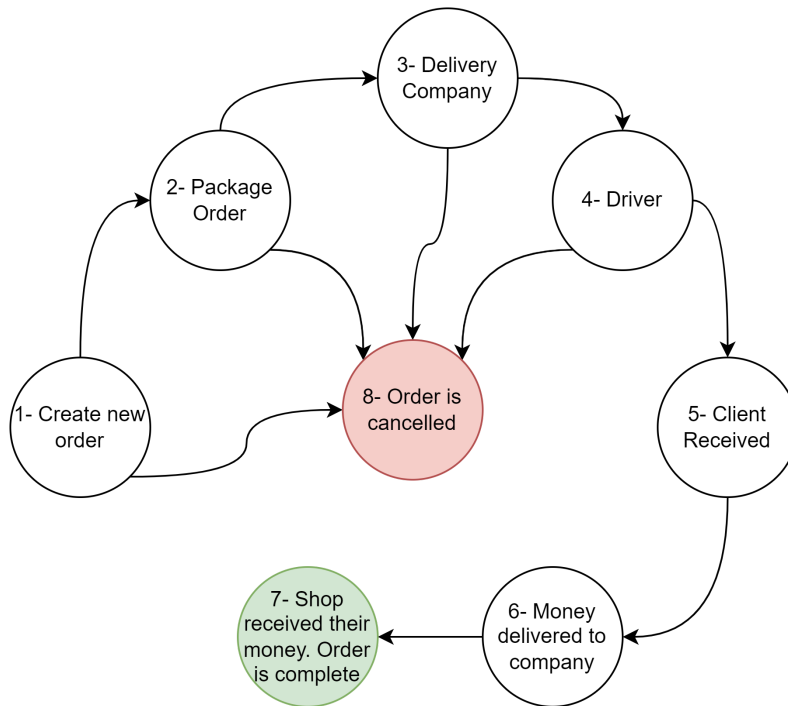
- Online shops
- Delivery Companies
- Clients shopping online.

To automate and manage this process, we will describe the above steps in more detail, and explain the critical points that need automation and better management. The main users of this platform will be the delivery companies, and this will be explained as well in the next sections.

Detailed Process:

1. Create new Order
2. Package Order
3. Delivery Company
4. Driver
5. Client Received
6. Money delivered to company
7. Shop received their money (order is COMPLETE).
8. Canceled

The diagram below visualizes the above detailed process. Both the online shop and delivery company will have visibility over all the steps, but the client will have visibility till step 5. The below details are explanations of the steps from both a business and technical perspective: business is what usually happens, and technical is our vision of how the platform will work.



1- Create new Order:

- Online shop creates a new order, and a tracking number is generated to be used by all the parties (mainly the client to track their order, and then the online shop to track their money received). The tracking number will be used to track this order and know in which step it is.
- This step helps shops keep track of all the orders that need to be prepared, packaged and sent to the delivery company.
- This step helps delivery companies see if there are any upcoming orders to be able to better manage the drivers or communicate with the online shops to ensure they are packaged and sent to the delivery company before the driver comes and picks up the existing orders.
- The user (online shop) should have the ability to add notes to the order when created (example: do not package this order before this date, or do not deliver until this date, etc...).
- **FUTURE:** In case the platform supports multiple delivery companies for a single shop, we need to add an option to specify the delivery company.
- **FUTURE:** in case the delivery platform is integrated with online shops, orders created from the shop website are sent to the platform directly.

2- Package Order:

- This step helps the shop to keep track of packaged orders to make sure they are all sent to the delivery company and not miss any.
- This step helps clients to know if their order is packaged or not, so they can contact the shop. This is not good for the shops in case they were slow in packaging orders, and at the same time will encourage them to work faster.
- This step helps delivery companies see if there are any upcoming orders to be able to better manage the drivers or communicate with the online shops to ensure they are packaged and sent to the delivery company before the driver comes and picks up the existing orders.
- In case the client sees that their order is not in this step yet, they will know if they can add to their order or not. The bad thing in this step is that the client **might think** that they cannot add to their order while the shop can unpackage the order and add more items to it.

3- Send to Delivery Company:

- When the order becomes in this state, the shop will know that there's nothing left from their side. In other words, any order that's still in a previous state is the shop's responsibility.
- The delivery company can use the number of orders in this state to track their inventory.
- When the orders are tracked in this state, the drivers might know when to come to the delivery company and pick orders. Example, if the driver comes each day and finds a small number of orders, they will come less frequently when they know there are not too many orders. And the other way around: if the drivers come each 2-3 days, using this state, they will come each day if they know there are many pending orders in the delivery company inventory.
- The question that needs discussion is who's responsible for moving the order to this state: does the online shop move the order to state #3 (this one) after they send it to the delivery company, or does the delivery company move it after they confirm they have received this order? This can also be optional or configurable by a setting when installing the platform for each company.

4- Driver (Optional):

- This step is optional, since from the client and shop perspective, it's now with the delivery company. Whether it's in the company's inventory or the driver doesn't matter for both of them (since the driver sometimes picks up the orders but does not deliver them on the same day).
- This helps delivery companies only to track the order if it's given to the driver or not. In case this state was not added to the platform, all the orders that are with the delivery company and the driver will have the same state, and this might create confusion between them. A solution might be to show the delivery company 2 states, but the shop and the client a single state.

- This state can help the clients estimate when their order will be delivered to them. This depends on their address and on the driver (how frequently they deliver to a certain place).
- In case we want to hide this state from the client, we should add an “estimated arrival” note for the client.

5- Client Received:

- The driver is responsible for moving the order to this status when they deliver it to the client.
- When the clients receive their order (i.e the order is moved to state 5) the online shop is notified and they can ask their client for feedback.
- There's an issue in case the driver do not move the order to this state, but this can be solved:
 - If the driver moves the order to this state **before delivering it to the client**, the client will receive a message that they received their order (and they will not accept it) and the online shop as well which will contact the client for feedback and know about this conflict. This will cause issues to the delivery companies, so they will force the drivers to move the orders to this state **only if they are delivered to the client**.
 - If the driver moves the order to this state **after delivering it by several days to the client**, this will create conflicts between the shop and delivery companies: “My order was delivered several days before and I wasn't notified, and I didn't contact the client for feedback” so the delivery companies will force the drivers to move it to this state once it's delivered to the client, or at least at the same day. Also, if the driver is late in moving the order to this state, later on, this will show that the delivery company is not delivering the orders fast, and it will affect the company's reputation, which is the last thing they want (delivery companies challenge each other by how fast they are). So this is another reason that makes the companies force the drivers to be accurate in logging this state.
- This state will help delivery companies track all the orders that they did not receive their money yet, by checking the ones with this state. In other words, delivery company should contact the driver and get all the money of orders in this state, and then move the order to State #6.
- OPTIONAL (needs discussion): clients can log that they received the order and then it's moved to this state. However, it will be an issue if they did this by mistake, and the shop or the driver need to revert it back to the previous state (#4 Driver) until it's really delivered.

6- Money Received:

- When the driver delivers the order to the client, they collect the money from them, and they are required to give this money to the delivery company, and therefore to the shop. The order is moved to this state when the delivery company receives the money.
- Visibility: the client will no longer see the state of the order, since from their perspective they received the order and they no longer have any business.

- This state will save delivery companies time in creating a report for the shops for the orders that have their money ready.
- This state will help online shops know the amount of money they should expect to receive from the delivery companies, or what money is now ready to be collected.

7- Shop Received:

- When the shop receives their money from the delivery company, the order is moved to this state, and the order is now set as COMPLETE.
- This state can help online shops in statistics, mainly, they can count all the orders with this state to know the total number of orders they have.
- Responsibility (to be discussed): who is responsible for moving the order to this state? Is it the delivery company or the online shop?
 - Delivery Company: if they set the order to this state and did not pay the money to the online shop, it will create theft issues.
 - Online Shop: if they receive the money from the delivery company but do not move this order, this will create the same issue, but the shop is the thief in this case.
 - A good solution could be that both shop and delivery company are responsible for consenting that they paid/received money for the order to become COMPLETE.
 - This might be better discussed with delivery companies, and it might be configurable and specific for each delivery company.

8- Canceled:

- Any order that is not delivered to the client can be set to “Canceled” and there might be tons of reasons.
- Any order set to “Canceled” must have a note stating the reason for cancellation.

Nice-to-Have Features in the Future:

- Live tracking for orders.
- Dashboards and Statistics for both Shops and Delivery Companies.
- Integration with online shops websites (explained earlier in state #1).
- Available delivery companies (with the clients feedback and rating, shops feedback and ratings, lead time, lead time by districts, drivers, etc...).
- Have drivers as users in the platform, so a driver might work with several companies, and people might add their feedback about the driver himself and not just the company as a whole.